General Dessert #5: Operating Courtesies and On-Air Conduct

Frequency access, distress traffic, interference resolution, band-plan separations, net management, and RACES drill limits.

Group G2B · 11 pool questions · Self-study reference · Practice exams at eham.net/exams

Key Facts Reference

Frequency Access and Priority

Question	Answer	Q
Who has priority access to a frequency	**Except during emergencies, no amateur station has priority access to any frequency.**	G2B01
If a station in distress breaks in	**Acknowledge the station in distress and determine what assistance may be needed.**	G2B02
Interference appears mid-contact due to propagation change	**Resolve it with the other stations in a mutually acceptable manner.**	G2B03

Minimum Separations and Frequency Selection

Question	Answer	Q
Min separation when selecting a CW frequency	**150 Hz to 500 Hz.**	G2B04
Min separation when selecting an SSB frequency	**2 kHz to 3 kHz.**	G2B05
How to check a clear frequency before calling CQ	**Send “QRL?” on CW with your call, or on phone ask “is the frequency in use?” with your call.**	G2B06
Choosing a frequency to initiate a call	**Follow the voluntary band plan.**	G2B07
Band-plan restriction for 50.1-50.125 MHz from the lower 48	**Only contacts with stations not within the 48 contiguous states.**	G2B08

Nets and RACES

Question	Answer	Q
Good practice for net management	**Have a backup frequency in case of interference or poor conditions.**	G2B10
Who may be the control op for RACES during a disaster	**Only a person holding an FCC-issued amateur operator license.**	G2B09
How often RACES drills/tests may be routinely conducted	**No more than 1 hour per week** (without special authorization).	G2B11

Dessert 5 Question Bank (G2B)

G2B01. Which of the following is true concerning access to frequencies?
A. Nets have priority
B. QSOs in progress have priority
C. Except during emergencies, no amateur station has priority access to any frequency
D. Contest operations should yield to non-contest use of frequencies

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G2B02. What is the first thing you should do if you are communicating with another amateur station and hear a station in distress break in?
A. Inform your local emergency coordinator
B. Acknowledge the station in distress and determine what assistance may be needed
C. Immediately decrease power to avoid interfering with the station in distress
D. Immediately cease all transmissions

G2B03. What is good amateur practice if propagation changes during a contact creating interference from other stations using the frequency?
A. Advise the interfering stations that you are on the frequency and that you have priority
B. Decrease power and continue to transmit
C. Attempt to resolve the interference problem with the other stations in a mutually acceptable manner
D. Switch to the opposite sideband

G2B04. When selecting a CW transmitting frequency, what minimum separation from other stations should be used to minimize interference to stations on adjacent frequencies?
A. 5 Hz to 50 Hz
B. 150 Hz to 500 Hz
C. 1 kHz to 3 kHz
D. 3 kHz to 6 kHz

G2B05. When selecting an SSB transmitting frequency, what minimum separation should be used to minimize interference to stations on adjacent frequencies?
A. 5 Hz to 50 Hz
B. 150 Hz to 500 Hz
C. 2 kHz to 3 kHz
D. Approximately 6 kHz

G2B06. How can you avoid harmful interference on an apparently clear frequency before calling CQ on CW or phone?
A. Send “QRL?” on CW, followed by your call sign; or, if using phone, ask if the frequency is in use, followed by your call sign
B. Listen for 2 minutes before calling CQ
C. Send the letter “V” in Morse code several times and listen for a response, or say “test” several times and listen for a response
D. Send “QSY” on CW or if using phone, announce “the frequency is in use,” then give your call sign and listen for a response

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G2B07. Which of the following complies with commonly accepted amateur practice when choosing a frequency on which to initiate a call?
A. Listen on the frequency for at least two minutes to be sure it is clear
B. Identify your station by transmitting your call sign at least 3 times
C. Follow the voluntary band plan
D. All these choices are correct

G2B08. What is the voluntary band plan restriction for US stations transmitting within the 48 contiguous states in the 50.1 MHz to 50.125 MHz band segment?
A. Only contacts with stations not within the 48 contiguous states
B. Only contacts with other stations within the 48 contiguous states
C. Only digital contacts
D. Only SSTV contacts

G2B09. Who may be the control operator of an amateur station transmitting in RACES to assist relief operations during a disaster?
A. Only a person holding an FCC-issued amateur operator license
B. Only a RACES net control operator
C. A person holding an FCC-issued amateur operator license or an appropriate government official
D. Any control operator when normal communication systems are operational

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G2B10. Which of the following is good amateur practice for net management?
A. Always use multiple sets of phonetics during check-in
B. Have a backup frequency in case of interference or poor conditions
C. Transmit the full net roster at the beginning of every session
D. All these choices are correct

G2B11. How often may RACES training drills and tests be routinely conducted without special authorization?
A. No more than 1 hour per month
B. No more than 2 hours per month
C. No more than 1 hour per week
D. No more than 2 hours per week

Answer Key

G2B01: C	G2B02: B	G2B03: C	G2B04: B
G2B05: C	G2B06: A	G2B07: C	G2B08: A
G2B09: A	G2B10: B	G2B11: C	